department to hear “firsthand” about what was happening on the front. At 12:00, my interlocutor reported to me that our sentries along the Suez Canal had reported that the earthen ramparts along the Canal had been breached with water cannons. “And what is your assessment?” I asked him. His response was, “Our assessment remains that this activity is part of the Egyptian military exercise!” I said goodbye to him and added, “See you after the war.” I kissed my wife and children, got into my car, and drove to my unit and the Syrian front of the war.

I returned from the war after the cease-fire came into effect and found myself in an internal discussion at the Mossad about whether it was wise for Mossad employees exposed to sensitive state secrets to participate in wars in combat units and on the front lines. This discussion was particularly germane because it took place following the Syrian capture of an intelligence officer from unit 848 (which later became 8200) at the Hermon outpost. The information that the officer, Amos Levinberg, gave up in his interrogations by the Syrians caused great damage to the IDF’s intelligence apparatus.

The state commission of inquiry headed by Chief Justice Shimon Agranat was a direct result of the failings revealed by the Yom Kippur War. Mossad chief Zvi Zamir was among those who received advance notice from the commission that he would be summoned to testify. He prepared for his testimony by establishing an interunit team to assist him and appointed me as its head. The objective of the team’s work, as defined by Zamir, was to present the Mossad’s intelligence contribution to the war. The period of time examined by the team was between the end of the War of Attrition on August 8, 1970, and the outbreak of the Yom Kippur War on October 6, 1973.

The Mossad director formulated his theses or insights related to the war during the three years that preceded it, based on his personal and intensive handling of Ashraf Marwan, meetings with other top sources, the reading and approving of all of the intelligence that came through as raw material throughout this period to the highest- ranking officials, and working meetings and consultations with the top security and political echelons, with the exception of those with Defense Minister Dayan, to which the head of the Mossad was not invited. There is no doubt that the Mossad chief’s military past helped him in reading the vast intelligence material and in understanding the strategic and doctrinal issues, as well as the tactical ones.